
Session 21: Graphic Design 2: Image Editing in the Browser

Presented by

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The Two Types of Digital Art

Raster (Photos)

- Made of tiny colored squares called pixels. If you zoom in too much, the image gets blurry and pixelated. (Formats: JPEG, PNG). *This is what we are editing today!*

Vector (Logos/Fonts)

- Made of mathematical formulas. You can stretch a vector logo to the size of a billboard, and it will never lose quality. (Formats: SVG, AI).



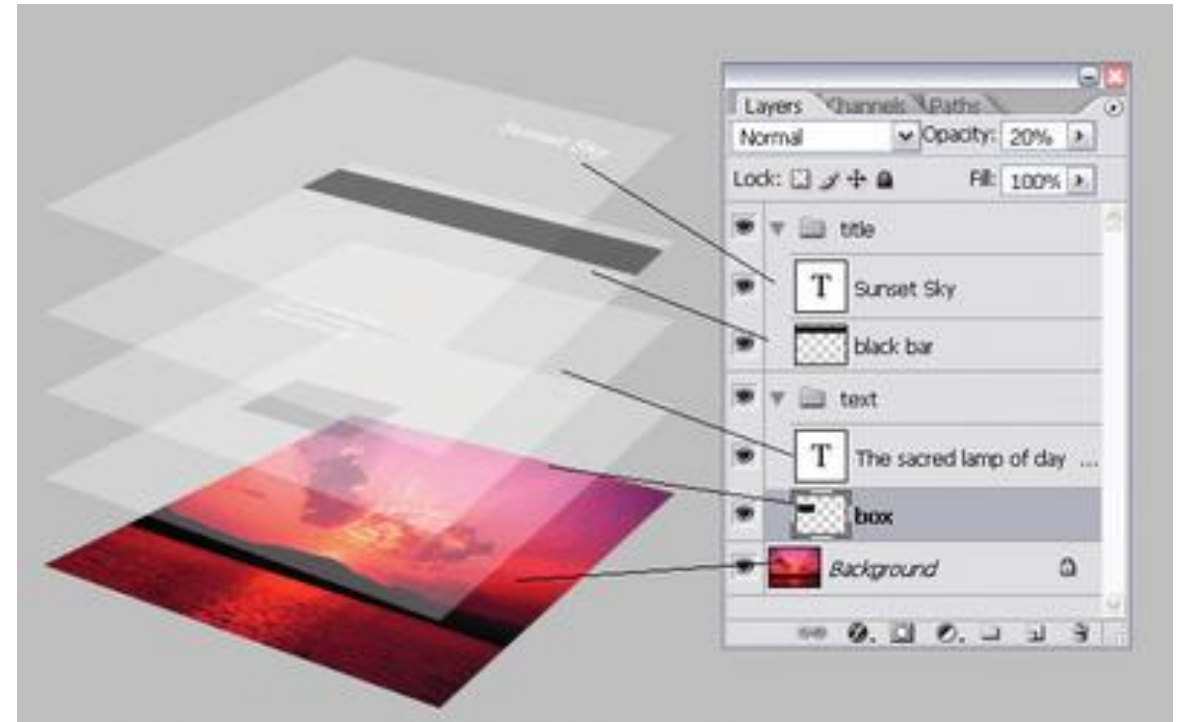
Professional Editing in your Browser

- What is it? A free, professional photo editor that lives entirely on the internet.
- Why use it?
 - Zero installation required,
 - works on almost any PC
 - uses the exact same interface and shortcuts as Adobe Photoshop.
- If you learn Photopea, you know Photoshop!
- Link: www.photopea.com

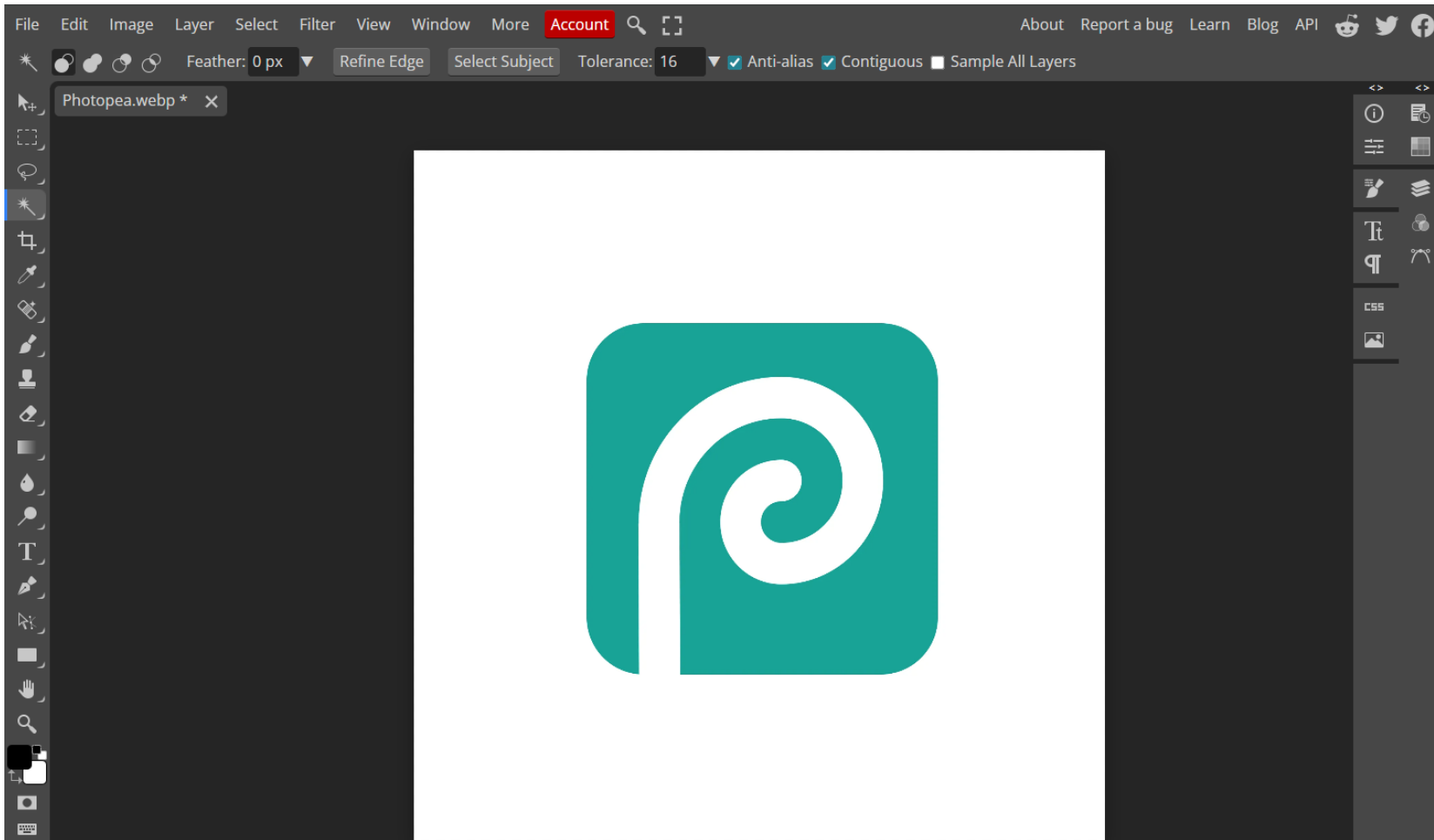


Understanding "Layers"

- **The Analogy:** Think of layers like transparent sheets of glass stacked on top of a desk.
- You can paint on one piece of glass without ruining the painting on the glass below it.
- **The Rule:** Whatever is on the top layer covers up what is underneath it. Always put your text on the top layer, and your background on the bottom layer!



Where is everything?



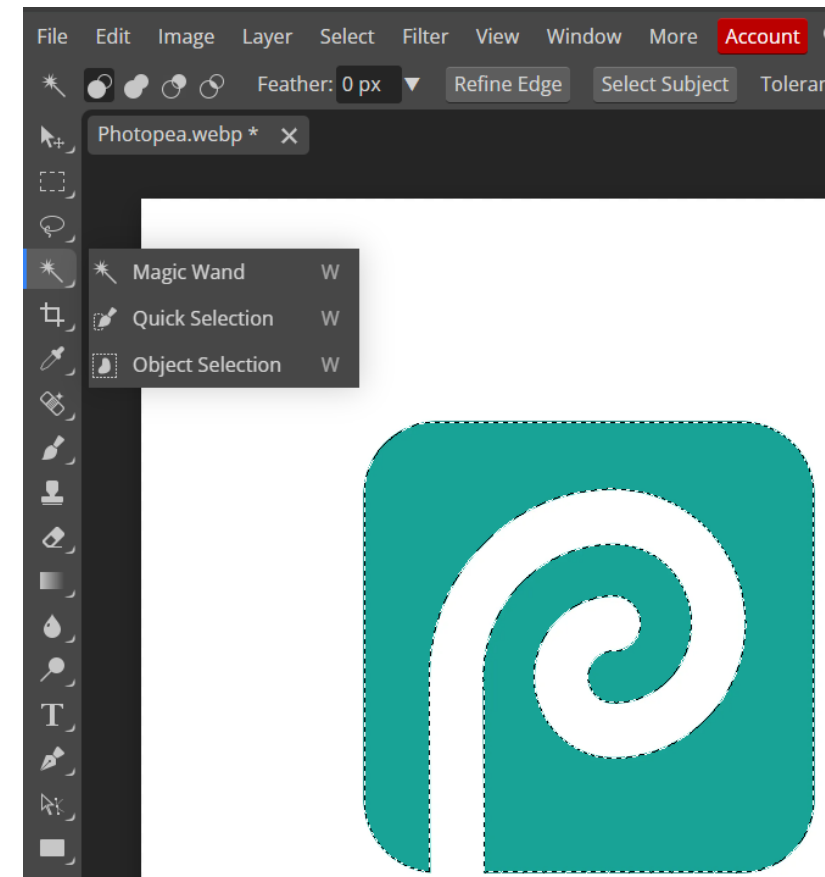
Your Core Toolkit

- **Move Tool (V):** The black arrow at the top. Used to drag things around.
- **Magic Wand Tool (W):** Used to click and select solid colors (like a white background) to easily delete them.
- **Type Tool (T):** To add text elements.
- **Free Transform (Alt + Ctrl + T):** Used to resize or rotate an image.

(Always hold the 'Shift' key while dragging the corners so the image doesn't stretch out of proportion!)

Isolating a Subject (Background Removal)

- Step 1: Bring your photo into the canvas.
- Step 2: Select the Magic Wand tool.
- Step 3: Click on the solid background color you want to remove.
- Step 4: Press the Delete or Backspace key on your keyboard.
- Notice the checkerboard pattern? That means the background is now completely transparent!



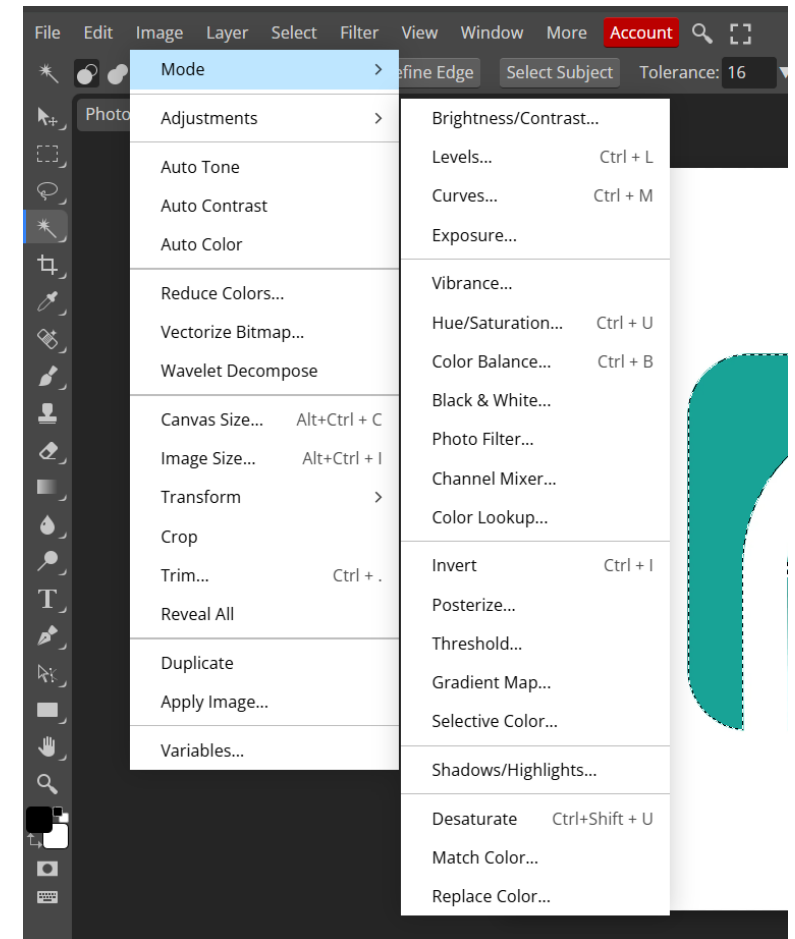
Sanding Down the Rough Edges

- **The Problem:** The Magic Wand sometimes leaves a jagged, pixelated "halo" around your object. It looks like it was cut out with cheap scissors!
- **The Solution:** The "Expand and Feather" trick.
- **Step 1:** Select your background with the Magic Wand.
- **Step 2:** Go to **Select → Modify → Expand** (Set to 1px).
This makes the selection bite into your object to hide the halo.
- **Step 3:** Go to **Select → Modify → Feather** (Set to 1px).
This acts like digital sandpaper to gently soften the edge.
- **Step 4:** Now press Delete!

Making Dull Photos "Pop"

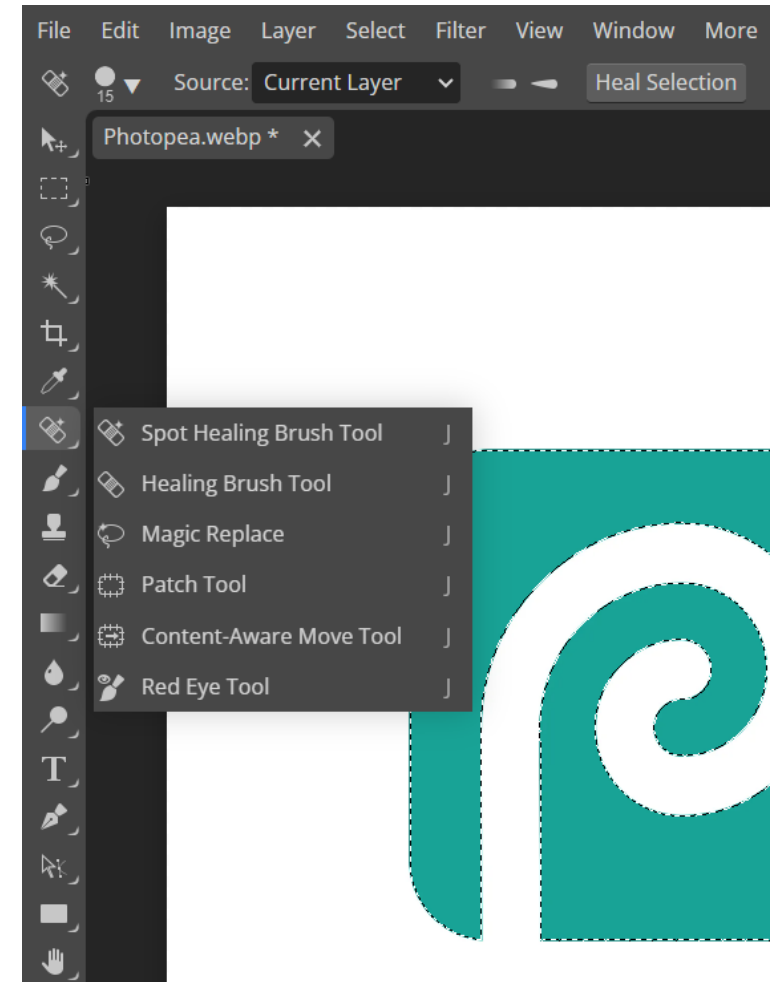
- **The Problem:** Smartphone photos often look too dark or lack color when viewed on a monitor.
- **The Fix:** Go to the top menu and click **Image → Adjustments**.
- **Brightness/Contrast:** Use this to make the whites whiter and the darks darker.
- **Hue/Saturation:** Use this to make the colors richer. (Slide the "Saturation" bar slightly to the right to make a product look brand new).

Warning: Do not over-edit! Pushing the saturation too far makes the photo look fake.



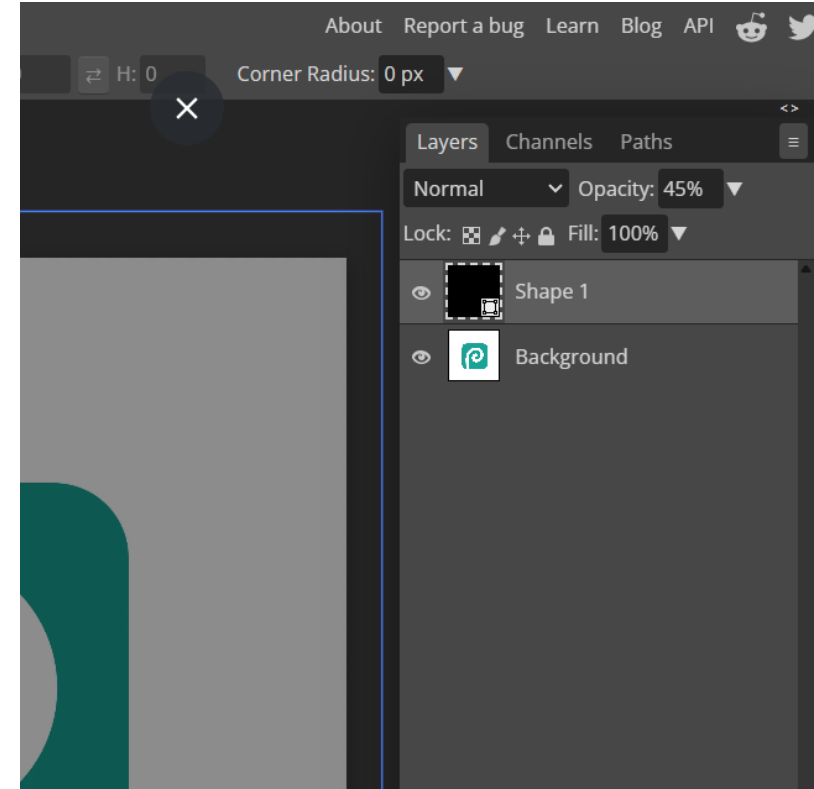
Removing Blemishes & Scratches

- **The Problem:** Your product photo has a scratch on it, or there is dust on the lens.
- **The Tool:** The Spot Healing Brush Tool (looks like a band-aid in the left toolbar).
- **How it works:** Adjust your brush size, click directly on the blemish, and Photopea's AI will analyze the pixels around it and magically cover it up.



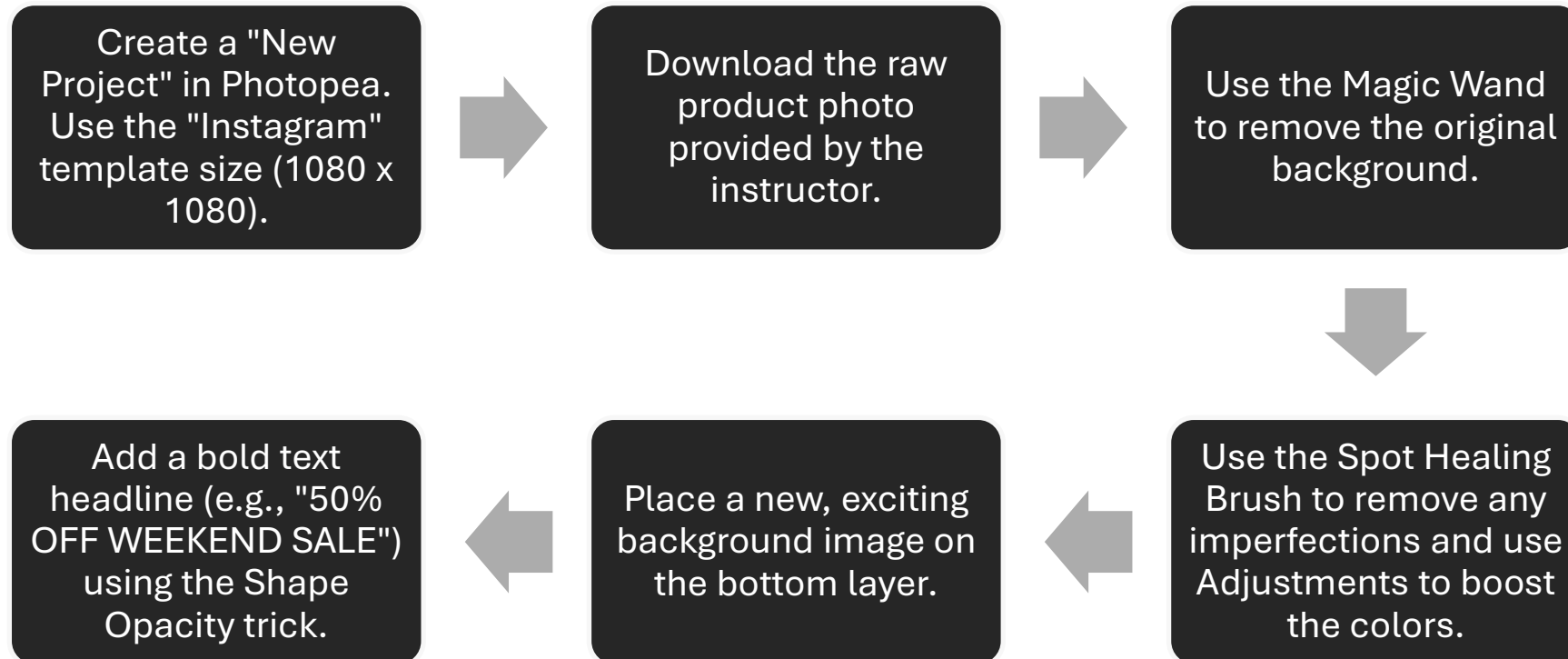
Making Text Stand Out on Busy Backgrounds

- **The Problem:** White text placed over a colorful, busy photograph is impossible to read.
- The Corporate Solution:
 1. Use the **Shape Tool (U)** to draw a black or dark grey rectangle behind your text.
 2. Go to your Layers Panel on the right.
 3. Find the "**Opacity**" slider at the top of the panel and lower it to 50%.
 4. You now have a sleek, semi-transparent glass box that makes text readable without hiding the photo!



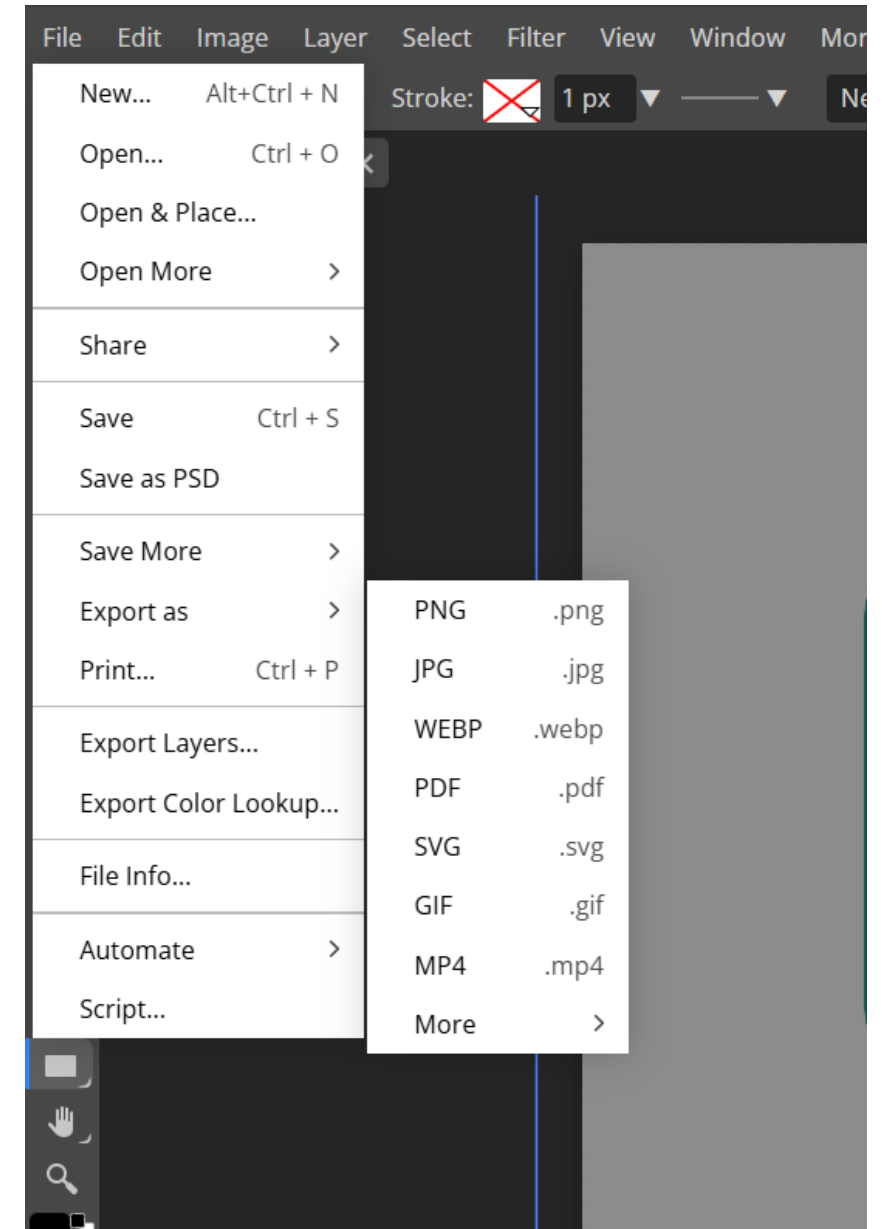
Activity: The Agency Ad Campaign

- The Mission: A local client needs a promotional post for an upcoming sale.



Exporting the Final Artwork

- You cannot just click "Save" if you want to post it online!
- **File → Export As → PNG:**
The best quality for social media graphics, and it preserves transparent backgrounds.
- **File → Save as PSD:**
Saves the raw project file with all your layers intact so you can open it tomorrow and continue editing.



Send Me Your Thoughts (Anonymously!)

*Scan the QR code and share your
questions or feedback*

<https://forms.gle/oKg7kAJNLI3Gcv7n7>

Thank You!

